

## 2. Technique

Assessed under this heading are the techniques that connect the language: bass line shaping, understanding of voice-leading and modulation, continuity of texture from a given opening.

|                        |                                                    |
|------------------------|----------------------------------------------------|
| <b>13–15<br/>marks</b> | Very secure control of all necessary techniques.   |
| <b>10–12<br/>marks</b> | Mainly secure control of all necessary techniques. |
| <b>7–9<br/>marks</b>   | Moderate control of most necessary techniques.     |
| <b>4–6<br/>marks</b>   | Limited control of some techniques.                |
| <b>1–3<br/>marks</b>   | A little technical control.                        |
| <b>0<br/>marks</b>     | No technical control.                              |

### 3. Notation

Assessed under this heading: communication by the accurate and legible use of staff notation.

|                   |                                                |
|-------------------|------------------------------------------------|
| <b>9–10 marks</b> | Entirely accurate/clear.                       |
| <b>7–8 marks</b>  | Mostly accurate/clear.                         |
| <b>5–6 marks</b>  | Moderately accurate/clear.                     |
| <b>3–4 marks</b>  | Clear in parts/some inaccuracy.                |
| <b>1–2 marks</b>  | Unclear/many inaccuracies.                     |
| <b>0 marks</b>    | No attention given to accuracy and legibility. |

## Section B: Instrumental Techniques

**45 marks**

### 1. Materials

Assessed under this heading: the quality of ideas and musical language that candidates present in their compositions or arrangements; evidence of aural familiarity with a range of listening demonstrated in the composition itself and outlined in the commentary. In arrangement, credit should be given for additional ideas that go beyond the given materials of the lead sheet.

|                   |                                                                                                           |
|-------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>9–10 marks</b> | Strong, inventive and confidently shaped materials informed by a broad range of highly relevant language. |
| <b>7–8 marks</b>  | Effectively shaped materials informed by a range of relevant language.                                    |
| <b>5–6 marks</b>  | Competent shaping of materials with some reference to appropriate language.                               |
| <b>3–4 marks</b>  | Some awkwardness in the shaping of materials with reference to a limited range of language.               |
| <b>1–2 marks</b>  | Indistinctive, poorly shaped materials. Little evidence of aural familiarity with relevant models.        |
| <b>0 marks</b>    | Negligible materials. No evidence of aural familiarity with listening models.                             |

### 2. Use of Medium

Assessed under this heading: the effectiveness of the writing for the chosen instrumentation; idiomatic understanding of instruments in both technical and expressive terms.

|                    |                                                    |
|--------------------|----------------------------------------------------|
| <b>13–15 marks</b> | Inventive and wholly idiomatic use of instruments. |
| <b>10–12 marks</b> | Mostly idiomatic use of instruments.               |
| <b>7–9 marks</b>   | Competent use of instruments.                      |
| <b>4–6 marks</b>   | Simple use of instruments.                         |

### 3. Technique

Assessed under this heading: the candidates' ability to develop, combine and connect their ideas on the small scale, e.g. handling motifs, extending phrases, constructing rhythmic textures, exploring harmonic variation. The pacing of events, the use of contrast and repetition and the overall balance of the ideas within the larger structure will also be considered.

|                   |                                                      |
|-------------------|------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>9–10 marks</b> | Very secure control of all appropriate techniques.   |
| <b>7–8 marks</b>  | Mainly secure control of all appropriate techniques. |
| <b>5–6 marks</b>  | Moderate control of most appropriate techniques.     |
| <b>3–4 marks</b>  | Limited control of some appropriate techniques.      |
| <b>1–2 marks</b>  | A little technical control.                          |
| <b>0 marks</b>    | No technical control.                                |

### 4. Communication

Assessed under this heading: the ability of candidates to communicate their work effectively in both written and recorded format. Accuracy of notation and the use of a range of performance/ expressive detail are to be considered in the score; the expressive aural communication of the composer's intentions is assessed in the recording.

|                   |                                                                                           |
|-------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>9–10 marks</b> | Accurate, detailed score with vivid communication in recording.                           |
| <b>7–8 marks</b>  | Clearly presented score; an effective recording.                                          |
| <b>5–6 marks</b>  | Mostly accurate score; some effectiveness in recording.                                   |
| <b>3–4 marks</b>  | Inaccuracies in the score: limited effectiveness in recording.                            |
| <b>1–2 marks</b>  | Incomplete notation; a little effectiveness in recording.                                 |
| <b>0 marks</b>    | Notation and/or recording missing; inadequate communication of the composer's intentions. |

Further guidance on the application of the following Mark Schemes will be given at annual training events and also may be found within the Guidance for Teachers booklet (see OCR website for more detail).

## Section A: Stylistic Techniques

45 marks

### 1. Language

Aspects of relevant musical language assessed under this heading include: appropriate selection and extended range of chords and idiomatic progressions in string quartet/keyboard accompaniment/chorale writing, etc; the treatment of vertical intervals/dissonance in vocal counterpoint; harmonic implications in linear writing in two-part keyboard counterpoint; the addition of further motifs/ostinati in minimalism; the effective use of derived forms of a series.

|                    |                                                                        |
|--------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>13–15 marks</b> | Wholly appropriate use of a very wide range of relevant language.      |
| <b>10–12 marks</b> | Almost entirely appropriate use of a wide range of relevant language.  |
| <b>7–9 marks</b>   | Mainly appropriate use of a representative range of relevant language. |
| <b>4–6 marks</b>   | Some appropriate use of a limited range of relevant language.          |
| <b>1–3 marks</b>   | Some use of relevant language.                                         |
| <b>0 marks</b>     | No use of any relevant language.                                       |

### 2. Technique

Aspects of technique assessed under this heading include: awareness of voice leading; command of bass line/melodic construction; the derivation of a well-shaped bass line implicit in a more complex chord progression. The interaction between voices in serial exercises, the pacing of the development of motifs/pitches in minimalism and the construction and handling of appropriate accompanimental figurations and textures are all relevant.

|                    |                                                      |
|--------------------|------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>13–15 marks</b> | Very secure control of all appropriate techniques.   |
| <b>10–12 marks</b> | Mainly secure control of all appropriate techniques. |

|                  |                             |
|------------------|-----------------------------|
| <b>1-3 marks</b> | A little technical control. |
| <b>0 marks</b>   | No technical control.       |

### 3. Stylistic understanding

Aspects of stylistic understanding assessed under this heading include: awareness of appropriate textures; a sense of stylistic fluency within a popular song, for example, continuing an incipit; idiomatic use of harmony such as the appropriate treatment of dissonance in serialism. A sense of stylistic integrity overall should be demonstrated within the chosen genre.

|                    |                                                                                                                  |
|--------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>13–15 marks</b> | Thorough understanding of a comprehensive range of wholly relevant stylistic features convincingly demonstrated. |
| <b>10–12 marks</b> | Detailed understanding of a wide range of mostly relevant stylistic features demonstrated.                       |
| <b>7–9 marks</b>   | Broad understanding of a representative range of relevant stylistic features demonstrated.                       |
| <b>4–6 marks</b>   | Some understanding of a limited range of stylistic features demonstrated.                                        |
| <b>1–3 marks</b>   | A little understanding of a few stylistic features evident.                                                      |
| <b>0 marks</b>     | No awareness of style.                                                                                           |